

# My Name Is Ben Panackal If I Were a Package I'd Be pandas

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An introduction to my personal and professional life

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# 1 Introduction

1.1 Hello it is very nice to meet all of you; I look forward to learning and working with all of you!

## 1.2 Here is Some General Information About Me

- **Name:** Benjamin Panackal
- **Grade:** Sophomore
- **Majors:** Computer Science and Data Science
- **Motivation for taking class:**
  - I have an interest in Data Science and Machine Learning
  - I want to contribute to research during my undergrad here at UW Madison.
  - I thought this class would be a good way to pursue my passion and chase my goals
  - I hope to come out of this course knowing how to research and get good at data science

# 2 More About Me

## 2.1 My Hobbies

- **Physical Activity**

- Playing Volleyball

**i** Note

- I started playing in 6th grade

- Climbing

**i** Note

- I started about two years ago

- Weightlifting

**i** Note

- I started about five years ago

- **Everything Else**

- Building CS Projects

#### **i** Note

- I started about a year ago

- Playing Guitar

#### **i** Note

- I started about a two years ago

- Hanging Out With Friends
- Cooking
- Gaming
  - \* My preferred game of choice is League of Legends

#### **!** Important

- I hit masters this summer and swore to stop playing

## **2.2 My Background**

### **2.2.1 Where I'm from:**

Burlington, Wisconsin

### **2.2.2 Where's my family from:**

Kerala, India

## 3 My Professional Career

### 3.1 Classes

3.1.1 My highest completed stats course at UW Madison is STAT240

3.1.2 My highest completed computer science course at UW Madison is CS400

### 3.2 My Links

3.2.1 [My Github](#)

3.2.2 [My LinkedIn](#)

## 4 What Python Library Describes Me?

### 4.1 Pandas

I identify with the `pandas` library (McKinney 2010) because, like `pandas`, I strive to organize and clarify data. `Pandas` provides tools for manipulating structured data, and I believe in bringing structure and clarity to complex problems as well as tidyness.

Source: [Article Notebook](#)

As shown in Table 1, `pandas` easily handles data cleaning by removing incomplete records and adding calculated columns. This demonstrates how I approach problems: identifying issues, removing insignificant details, and deriving meaningful insights.

Source: [Article Notebook](#)

Table 1: Student data before and after cleaning with pandas

Raw Data (with issues):

|   | Student | Math_Score | Science_Score | GPA |
|---|---------|------------|---------------|-----|
| 0 | Alice   | 85.0       | 78            | 3.5 |
| 1 | Bob     | 90.0       | 82            | 3.8 |
| 2 | NaN     | 88.0       | 85            | 3.6 |
| 3 | Diana   | NaN        | 88            | 3.7 |
| 4 | Eve     | 92.0       | 91            | 3.9 |

Missing value counts:

```
Student      1
Math_Score   1
Science_Score 0
GPA          0
dtype: int64
```

Cleaned Data:

|   | Student | Math_Score | Science_Score | GPA | Average_Score |
|---|---------|------------|---------------|-----|---------------|
| 0 | Alice   | 85.0       | 78            | 3.5 | 81.5          |
| 1 | Bob     | 90.0       | 82            | 3.8 | 86.0          |
| 2 | Eve     | 92.0       | 91            | 3.9 | 91.5          |

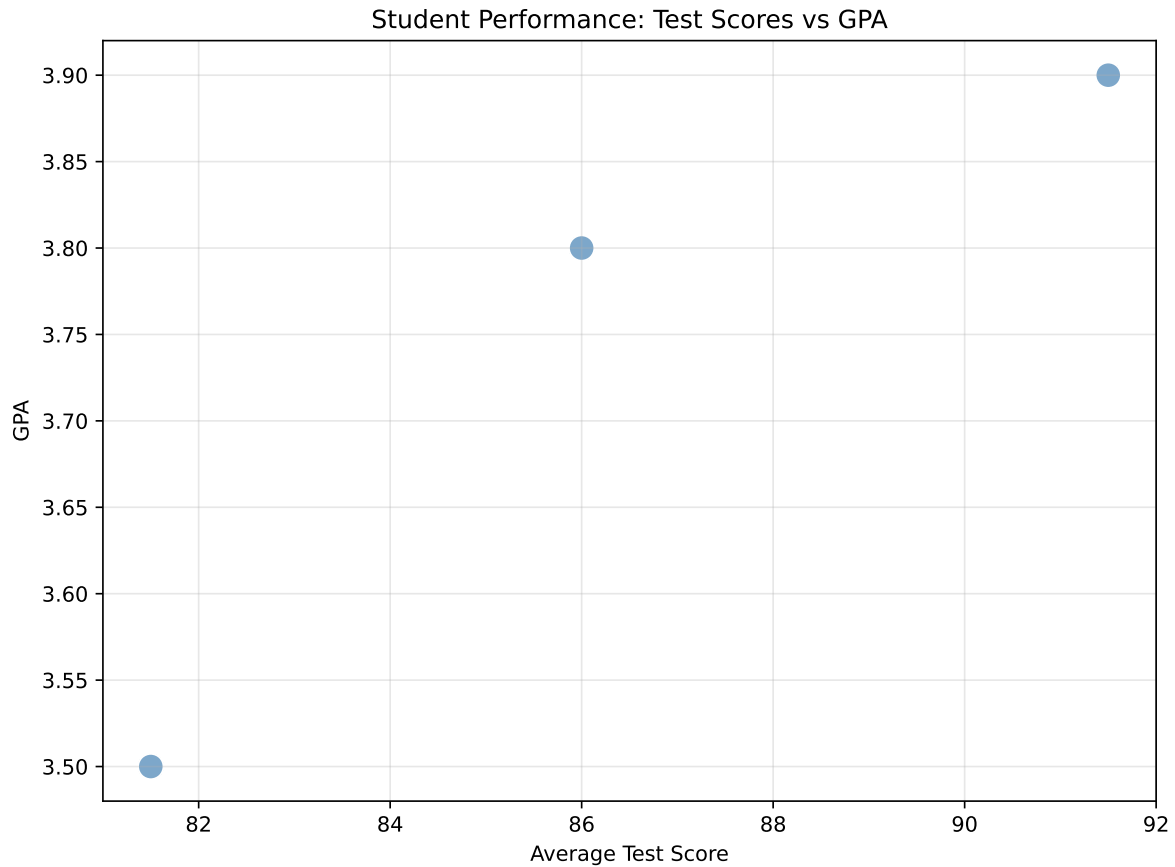


Figure 1: Relationship between GPA and average test scores

Source: [Article Notebook](#)

The visualization in Figure 1 shows the strong correlation between academic performance metrics, illustrating how organized data reveals patterns that raw, messy data obscures.

1

Source: [Article Notebook](#)

McKinney, Wes. 2010. “Data Structures for Statistical Computing in Python.” *Proceedings of the Python in Science Conference*, 56–61. <https://pandas.pydata.org/>.

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<sup>1</sup>By: Ben Panackal